

Christmas Dinner Menu Plan

Plan every course, decide who brings what, and enjoy the day you cooked for.

DINNER DATE _____

SERVING TIME _____

Tick the dishes you're serving, write in your own, and note who is making or bringing each one. Then flip to page 2 to shop and cook.

PAGE 1 OF 2 • THE MENU

Starters & Appetizers

dish • who's making it

- ☐ Shrimp cocktail _____
- ☐ Cheese & charcuterie board _____
- ☐ Stuffed mushrooms _____
- ☐ Soup or bisque _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Side Dishes

dish • who's making it

- ☐ Mashed potatoes _____
- ☐ Roasted vegetables _____
- ☐ Stuffing / dressing _____
- ☐ Green bean casserole _____
- ☐ Dinner rolls & butter _____
- ☐ _____

Desserts

dish • who's making it

- ☐ Christmas pudding _____
- ☐ Pumpkin or pecan pie _____
- ☐ Yule log / layer cake _____
- ☐ Cookies & sweets tray _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Main Course

dish • who's making it

- ☐ Roast turkey _____
- ☐ Honey-glazed ham _____
- ☐ Prime rib / beef roast _____
- ☐ Vegetarian main / nut roast _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Sauces & Extras

dish • who's making it

- ☐ Gravy _____
- ☐ Cranberry sauce _____
- ☐ Bread sauce _____
- ☐ Pickles & relishes _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Drinks & Toasts

dish • who's bringing it

- ☐ Mulled wine / cider _____
- ☐ Wine & sparkling _____
- ☐ Kids' punch / juice _____
- ☐ Coffee, tea & hot cocoa _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

Assign a dish to every guest who offers — sharing the cooking is the secret to a calm, joyful Christmas table.

Shopping List & Cooking Timeline

Shop by section, then work backward from dinner so nothing is left to the last minute.

GUESTS

FOOD BUDGET

Fill your grocery list from the menu on page 1, count your guests, then tick off the make-ahead tasks as the big day gets closer.

PAGE 2 OF 2 • SHOP & COOK

Shopping — Fresh

check as you buy

PRODUCE



MEAT, POULTRY & SEAFOOD



DAIRY & EGGS



Shopping — Pantry

check as you buy

BAKING & PANTRY



BAKERY & FROZEN



DRINKS & EXTRAS



Make-Ahead Timeline

work backward from dinner

UP TO 1 WEEK BEFORE

- ☐ Finalize menu & guest count
- ☐ Order turkey / ham / roast
- ☐ Shop non-perishables

2-3 DAYS BEFORE

- ☐ Buy fresh produce & dairy
- ☐ Thaw turkey in fridge
- ☐ Bake pies & desserts

CHRISTMAS EVE

- ☐ Prep veg, brine, set the table
- ☐ Make sauces & cranberry

CHRISTMAS DAY

- ☐ Roast the main · start early
- ☐ Sides in oven · rest the meat
- ☐ Reheat, plate & serve warm

Guest Headcount & RSVP

name · seats

GUEST / FAMILY

SEATS

Dietary needs, allergies & last-minute reminders

TOTAL GUESTS

COURSES PLANNED

DISHES MADE AHEAD

FOOD BUDGET